

Aethor Silvermoon — Wood Elf Monk (Way of the Open Hand)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Monk (Way of the Open Hand, locked) **Race:** Wood Elf **Level:** 3 **Role:** Mobile skirmisher — three strikes per turn, reposition at will, snipe back arrows **Personality Hook:** *Speaks like the answer's obvious. Never quite stops moving. Meditates mid-run.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +Wood Elf +2 DEX / +1 WIS)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	10	+0
DEX	17	+3
CON	14	+2
INT	8	-1
WIS	16	+3
CHA	8	-1

Combat Vitals

- **HP:** 34 (base 24 at L3 with CON 14 + **10 HP variant buffer**)
- **AC:** 16 (Unarmored Defense: 10 + DEX +3 + WIS +3)
- **Speed:** 45 ft (Wood Elf 35 + Monk Unarmored Movement 10)
- **Initiative:** +3
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d8

Saving Throws: STR +2, DEX +5

Skill Proficiencies: Acrobatics +5, Insight +5, Perception +5 (Keen Senses racial), Stealth +5

Senses: Darkvision 60 ft

Languages: Common, Elvish

Ki Save DC: 13 · **Ki Attack:** +5

Equipment

- **Quarterstaff** (versatile 1d6 / 1d8 two-handed) — primary monk weapon; Martial Arts lets him use DEX
- **Shortsword** (1d6 piercing, finesse, light) — alt monk weapon for TWF opportunity
- **10x Darts** (1d4 piercing, thrown 20/60, finesse) — ranged option (monk can throw as monk weapons)
- **Dungeoneer's Pack** (crowbar, hammer, 10 pitons, 10 torches, tinderbox, rations, waterskin)
- **No armor, no shield** — Unarmored Defense active
- **Starting trinket:** A worn prayer bead necklace he counts one-handed while thinking

Class & Race Features

Monk (L3)

- **Unarmored Defense (L1):** AC = 10 + DEX + WIS (no shield). Currently **16**.
- **Martial Arts (L1):** Use DEX instead of STR for unarmed strikes and monk weapons. Roll **1d4** as damage die for unarmed / monk weapons (or weapon die if higher). When you attack with an unarmed strike or monk weapon on your turn, you can make **one unarmed strike as a bonus action** (the “free” bonus strike — no ki cost).
- **Ki (L2):** 3 ki points (= monk level). Recover all on short or long rest.
 - **Flurry of Blows (1 ki):** Bonus action after Attack action — make **2 unarmed strikes** (replaces the free bonus strike; this is the upgrade).
 - **Patient Defense (1 ki):** Bonus action — take the Dodge action.
 - **Step of the Wind (1 ki):** Bonus action — Disengage or Dash, jump distance doubled for the turn.

- **Unarmored Movement (L2):** +10 ft speed when not wearing armor or a shield. Applied (45 ft total).
- **Monastic Tradition — Way of the Open Hand (L3): Open Hand Technique** — when you hit a creature with one of the attacks from Flurry of Blows, pick one rider:
 - Target must make a **DEX save DC 13** or be knocked **prone**.
 - Target must make a **STR save DC 13** or be **pushed 15 ft** away.
 - Target **can't take reactions** until the end of your next turn.
- **Deflect Missiles (L3):** Reaction when hit by a ranged weapon attack. Reduce damage by **1d10 + DEX +3 + Monk level +3 = 1d10 + 6 (avg 11.5)**. If the damage is reduced to 0, you catch the projectile and can spend **1 ki to throw it back** at the attacker as a ranged attack (+5, 1d10 + DEX, range 20/60).

Wood Elf

- **Darkvision 60 ft**
- **Keen Senses:** Perception proficiency
- **Fey Ancestry:** Advantage on saves vs. Charmed; immune to magical sleep (banned anyway).
- **Trance:** 4-hour meditation long rest (flavor).
- **Fleet of Foot:** Base speed **35 ft** (stacks with Unarmored Movement).
- **Mask of the Wild:** Can attempt to Hide when lightly obscured by natural terrain (foliage, mist, rain, falling snow). Map-dependent — strong on outdoor arenas.
- **Weapon Training:** Longsword, shortsword, shortbow, longbow (shortsword is the one that matters — monk weapon).

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **Three-Strike Flurry Turn.** Action: Attack with Quarterstaff two-handed (1d8+3 = avg 7.5). Bonus action: **Flurry of Blows (1 ki)** — 2 unarmed strikes (1d4+3 each = avg 5.5 each). **Open Hand rider on one hit:** knock target **prone** (DEX save DC 13). Total damage: **avg 18.5**, plus prone sets up advantage for the next melee ally. Three ki means he can do this three times per short rest — effectively three times per match in v1.
2. **Step-Strike Assassin.** Ki (Step of the Wind, 1 ki) as bonus action → **Dash**, 90 ft move through the arena to reach the back-line Wizard or Sorcerer. Action: Quarterstaff + free bonus unarmed. Total 13 avg damage on a character who thought they were safe 60 ft away. Alternative: use it to Disengage from a melee trap and kite at 45 ft/turn.
3. **Deflect-and-Return.** Enemy archer (Fighter, Ranger) shoots: Reaction → **Deflect Missiles**, reduce by 1d10+6 (avg 11.5). Most L3 ranged hits deal ~8–10 damage — this **cancels the hit outright** most of the time. Spend 1 ki: **throw it back** as a ranged attack (+5, 1d10 + DEX 3 = avg 8.5). A hard counter to the Fighter's Battle Master archery build.

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Attack (Quarterstaff 1d8+3 two-handed / 1d6+3 one-handed · Unarmed 1d4+3 · Shortsword 1d6+3 · Dart 1d4+3 thrown) · Dash · Dodge · Disengage · Hide
Bonus Action	Free unarmed strike (after Attack action, no ki) · Flurry of Blows (1 ki, 2 unarmed) · Patient Defense (1 ki, Dodge) · Step of the Wind (1 ki, Disengage or Dash)
Reaction	Deflect Missiles · Opportunity Attack
Movement	45 ft

Slot	Options
Free	Ki declaration, drop prone, object interaction

Damage Reference

- **Quarterstaff (two-handed):** $1d8 + 3 \text{ DEX} = \text{avg } 7.5$
- **Quarterstaff (one-handed) + unarmed bonus:** $1d6+3 + 1d4+3 = \text{avg } 6.5 + 5.5 = \mathbf{12 \text{ avg / 2 hits}}$
- **Quarterstaff + Flurry (1 ki):** $1d8+3 + 2 \times (1d4+3) = 7.5 + 11 = \mathbf{18.5 \text{ avg / 3 hits}}$
- **Unarmed only + Flurry (1 ki):** $3 \times (1d4+3) = \mathbf{16.5 \text{ avg / 3 hits}}$
- **Dart (thrown, 20/60):** $1d4 + 3 \text{ DEX} = \text{avg } 5.5$
- **Deflect Missiles reduction:** $1d10 + 6 = \text{avg } \mathbf{11.5 \text{ damage cancelled}}$
- **Deflected projectile return (1 ki):** $1d10 + 3 \text{ DEX} = \text{avg } 8.5 (+5 \text{ to hit})$

Town Phase Notes

- **Perception +5 + Stealth +5 + Acrobatics +5** — strong Catacomb-hunt character. Pair him with the Druid on scouting runs.
- **Insight +5** — the Hag's Riddles station likely opens up for him.
- **Zero CHA** — stay away from Hagglings, Casino. Let the Bard / Paladin handle social.
- **No armor / no pack weight** — fastest traveler on the team for time-sensitive town legs.